

Jira Project Intake & Standards Guide

Process, naming conventions, and configuration standards for new Jira projects

Atlassian Platform Governance | 2021-2026

1. Purpose

This document defines the process for requesting a new Jira project, the standards every project must meet, and the criteria used to evaluate whether a project request is appropriate. It exists so that new projects are consistent, maintainable, and actually useful to the teams that use them.

2. Scope

Applies to all Jira Software and Jira Service Management project requests across all departments. Any team requesting a new Jira project follows this process, regardless of department or seniority of the requestor.

3. When to Request a New Project

Not every workflow needs its own Jira project. Before submitting a request, the requestor should confirm that the work meets at least one of the following criteria:

- The work involves a distinct team, department, or cross-functional group with its own workflows and ownership
- The work has a defined lifecycle: requests come in, get assigned, get resolved, and close
- There is a need to track status, priority, or accountability that cannot be handled in an existing project
- The team will actively manage and maintain the project on an ongoing basis

If the request is better served by a board in an existing project, a new issue type, or a Confluence page, the administrator will advise the requestor accordingly before any configuration work begins.

4. Intake Process

4.1 Submit a Request

All new project requests are submitted through the IT service desk portal. The request form collects the following information:

Field	Required?	Notes
Project name (proposed)	Yes	Must follow naming conventions in Section 5
Department or team owner	Yes	The team responsible for maintaining the project

Field	Required?	Notes
Project lead	Yes	Single named individual, not a group
Project type	Yes	Jira Software (sprints/kanban) or Jira Service Management (service desk)
Business purpose	Yes	What problem does this project solve?
Estimated users	Yes	Approximate number of people who will use this project
Workflow requirements	No	Custom statuses, transitions, or approval steps needed
SLA requirements (JSM only)	No	Response and resolution targets, if applicable
Integration needs	No	Links to other projects, Confluence spaces, or external tools
Requested go-live date	No	Used for scheduling, not a commitment

4.2 Review and Approval

The Jira administrator reviews each request within 3 business days. The review checks that:

- The request includes complete information
- The use case is appropriate for Jira and can't be met by an existing project
- The proposed naming and structure follows platform standards
- The request doesn't create a permission or governance conflict with existing projects

If the request is approved, the administrator schedules configuration and notifies the project lead. If the request needs clarification or the use case is better served another way, the administrator contacts the requestor directly before any work begins.

4.3 Configuration and Handoff

Once approved, the administrator configures the project according to the standards in Section 5 and the specific requirements captured in the request. Before go-live, the project lead is walked through the configuration, confirms it matches their requirements, and signs off. The administrator documents the project in the internal project registry.

5. Project Naming Conventions

All Jira projects follow a consistent naming pattern so that projects are identifiable at a glance in dashboards, filters, and reports.

Element	Standard	Example
Project name	Department or team name, plain language, no abbreviations unless widely understood	Customer Service Requests
Project key	2–5 uppercase letters, derived from project name, unique across the instance	CSR
JSM project names	Include the word 'Service Desk' or 'Support' to distinguish from Software projects	IT Service Desk, Finance Support
Project keys to avoid	Keys that duplicate or closely resemble existing keys, check before submitting	If IT exists, don't use ITT or IT2

6. Standard Configuration Applied to All Projects

Every new project is configured with the following baseline settings unless the request specifies otherwise:

6.1 Issue Types

Standard issue types are applied based on project type:

- Jira Software: Story, Task, Bug, Sub-task
- JSM: Service request types defined during intake (Request, Incident, Change, etc.)

6.2 Permission Scheme

New projects are assigned the default permission scheme unless the request identifies a need for custom access control. Any custom permission requirement is documented and reviewed before configuration.

6.3 Notification Scheme

The default notification scheme is applied. Teams can request adjustments after go-live through the standard change request process.

6.4 Workflows

Projects are configured with the default workflow unless the request specifies custom statuses or transitions. Custom workflows are documented in the workflow registry before deployment.

7. Project Lead Responsibilities

The project lead named at intake is accountable for the following on an ongoing basis:

- Keeping the project active, archiving or closing when the project is no longer in use
- Managing agent roles within JSM service desks (adding and removing team members)

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- Escalating configuration change requests to the Jira administrator
 - Responding to access audits within the required timeframe

8. Review and Maintenance

The Jira administrator conducts a quarterly review of all active projects. Projects with no activity in 90 days are flagged for review. Project leads are notified and given 10 business days to confirm the project should remain active or to request archival.

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